COUNTRY REPORTS: CÔTE D'IVOIRE

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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The strategy that governs Ivorian digital policy has aged out from under the machine that keeps producing new ones: the World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index records the country's digital transformation strategy as old and due for updating, and a whole-of-government approach as only planned or in draft, and the cybersecurity strategy still in force is the expired 2021-2025 text as at July 2026. Where a plan does exist it is an agency's rather than the state's: the universal-service agency presented a 2026-2030 strategic plan on 11 August 2026 on four pillars — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four followed by the supervising ministry at FCFA 60.144bn and six on the agency's own funds, targeting 300 newly connected localities, smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of national backbone fibre lit by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument for it is published.

The instrument being succeeded is the National Digital Development Strategy 2021-2025, organised around seven pillars including digital infrastructure and e-government, and its paperless-administration target for 2030 is now the frame against which almost every other decision is justified. The minister presented the national digital strategy as Côte d'Ivoire Numérique 2030 at VivaTech in June 2025. Two further strategies, on artificial intelligence and on data governance to 2030, were handed to the Prime Minister on 13 March 2025 as a paired set; the AI text is public, carried in full through the OECD's AI policy repository. A seminar in April 2026 aligned the AI, cybersecurity, data-governance and zero-paper strands under the Ministry of Digital Transition, which also carries a 2026-2028 roadmap of seven axes sitting beneath the national digital strategy and the PND 2026-2030.

Delivery belongs to that ministry, which the GovTech index records as an established institution with a whole-of-government mandate (2025) and whose allocation rose to CFA83.2 billion in 2026 from CFA60.78 billion in 2025. The capacity to run what has been written is being assembled after the fact: in May 2026, as the AI and data-governance strategies were being put into effect, the ministry opened a call for six senior posts to strengthen delivery of the state's digital projects, among them three technical advisers, a director of information systems and directors for the digital transformation of the administration and for digital infrastructure. Sector plans now follow the centre: the Ministry of Economy, Planning and Development adopted a 2026-2030 information system master plan in December 2025, 44 projects budgeted at CFA10.156 billion, after a diagnostic that found weak IT governance and multiple platforms that are not interconnected. The Digital Acceleration Project shortlisted six firms on 30 September 2026 to support implementation of the country's digital and artificial intelligence compact, whose own text is not held.

Legislation and regulation

The legal base for electronic signature and trust services in Côte d'Ivoire is older than almost everything now built on it: the national public key infrastructure rests on loi n°2013-546 of 30 July 2013 on electronic transactions, together with the 2014 and 2016 decrees on cryptology services, electronic signature and electronic archiving. The same 2013 package carries a law on the fight against cybercrime alongside the transactions law, and Law No. 2013-450 of 19 June 2013 on the protection of personal data, which grants rights of access, correction and deletion and makes the processing of sensitive data subject to prior authorisation by ARTCI.

Since then the state has legislated mainly by ordinance and decree; the one full sector statute is Loi n°2024-352 of 6 June 2024 on electronic communications, which covers licensing, spectrum, universal service, the regulator's powers and sanctions and repeals the 2012 ordinance. Ordonnance n°2017-500 of 2 August 2017 on electronic services is in force, and the Council of Ministers of 18 June 2025 adopted a decree formalising the digital nationality certificate, which gave the electronically issued certificate a legal basis rather than launching a service. Identity is the clearest case of the pattern: there is no single standalone digital identity law covering the full lifecycle, and the biometric card rests instead on Loi n°2019-566 of 2019, five articles that make enrolment compulsory from 16 and leave the card's technical specifications, application, renewal and the move off the paper card to the Council of Ministers.

Where digital-specific law is silent, general law does the work. Data-centre construction is caught by the environmental impact regime of Loi n°96-766 and Décret n°96-894, under which the Grand-Bassam project's impact study went to the Agence Nationale de l'Environnement for validation, and the framework for exchanging data between public bodies rests on the e-services ordinance and a 2021 decree adopting a general interoperability reference framework. Payments law is barely national at all: the binding rules are regional, from the WAEMU instruments governing electronic money to the central bank's interoperability deadline of 30 June 2026.

The telecoms regulator's head, speaking on World Post Day, 9 October 2026, called for the postal network to be adapted to the digital economy; the report records a revision of the 2013 Postal Code under way. Draft net-neutrality guidelines went to public consultation from 6 July to 6 August 2026, allowing zero rating only where it is non-discriminatory and unpaid; the regulator published the operators' responses in September.

Data protection

Côte d'Ivoire's data protection authority is its telecoms regulator: ARTCI is empowered to investigate and impose administrative penalties, must authorise the processing of sensitive data and keeps a public register of processing operations, and warned in June 2024 that biometric access and attendance control at work must comply with the 2013 law — the same body that regulates the operators it also supervises for data protection. The statute it enforces is the 2013 personal data law, and on the World Bank's 2025 GovTech Maturity Index the legislation is in force and assessed as effective, with a supervisory authority in place.

Where the regime is thinnest is exactly where the state is building fastest. Law No. 2013-450 sets conditions on interconnecting personal data files — that interconnection not infringe data subjects' rights, that appropriate security measures be used and that it respect the principle of relevance. Personal data may go abroad only to a country offering an equal or higher level of protection. Meanwhile the state has financed surveillance with Bank of China lending, paying for video surveillance and licence plate readers across Abidjan, Yamoussoukro, Bouaké, Odienné, Korhogo and San Pedro and for a national emergency command centre with surveillance towers in cities across the country.

Two measured rights indicators have fallen while governance overall improved: digital freedom fell 11.3 points over 2014-2023 to 62.6 out of 100, 22nd of 54 African states, and Personal Liberties is among the country's ten worst-scoring measures at 32.8 out of 100 and 35th of 54, down 10.1 points over the same decade.

Regional collaboration

The region's own budget carries almost nothing for its digital agenda: the ECOWAS Community MTEF Budget 2026-2028 has a single ICT-named programme line, which records nil actual spend from 2024 through the 2028 estimates. The ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029 was adopted at Cotonou on 4 October 2024, and the same meeting required every member state to have the ECOWAS Roaming Regulation fully implemented by all mobile operators by the end of 2025.

What crosses the border in practice runs on the central bank's rails rather than the Commission's. The BCEAO's interoperable instant payment system went live on 30 September 2025 with coverage still partial, interoperability becomes mandatory across the Union from 30 June 2026, and Côte d'Ivoire already leads the Union's cross-border electronic-money flows. Customs runs a working regional data exchange, SIGMAT, live since 2019.

Identity is the opposite case. Côte d'Ivoire is one of the countries implementing the ECOWAS-World Bank WURI programme, whose cross-border interoperability strategy for mutual recognition of foundational credentials was validated in March 2026 and remains an objective rather than a service. The perimeter it would cover has shrunk: Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger severed ties with ECOWAS in 2024 and have since built a separate Alliance of Sahel States credential stack — a common AES biometric passport in January 2025, AES-aligned biometric national ID cards in Burkina Faso in November 2025 and Niger in March 2026.

Data moves across the bloc on a commercial logic that points away from the sovereignty framing: the Grand-Bassam data centre's developer makes its case on Abidjan being UEMOA's regional centre, under a regulatory regime letting banks and financial institutions store and move data freely across the Union, making it a regional disaster-recovery site. Membership has not yet added up to integration: the country scores 46.3 out of 100 on Regional Integration in 2023, 28th of 54 African states.

Standards

The tightest operating standard over Ivorian digital services is written by the regional central bank rather than in Abidjan: BCEAO Instruction No. 001-03-2021 requires payment service providers to report to the central bank within 24 hours any incident interrupting service for more than two hours, with a detailed report within three calendar days and penalties for non-compliance, while Instruction No. 001-01-2024 counts a breach compromising the confidentiality of information systems and data as a major operational incident.

The country does now have an interoperability layer: UXP, an improved version of X-Road developed by Estonia's Cybernetica, deployed by the state IT company SNDI and launched in September 2025. SNDI gives the platform's open-source character among its stated reasons for the choice and traces the decision to a national digital-governance roadmap drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with the paperless-administration target. The constraint on making it bind is institutional rather than technical: the minister has called for clearer allocation of responsibility between ministries' information-system heads where one public service needs several agencies (July 2026).

Security and trust standards are further along than data standards. A general information systems security reference framework and a critical infrastructure protection plan are in force by decree, with a national CERT and a requirement that essential service operators regularly evidence their security implementation, and ANSSI-CI has commissioned a national public key infrastructure as the sovereign root of trust for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory. On identity, ONECI has joined the Secure Identity Alliance's OSIA initiative for open interoperability standards while the identity register, the health insurance database and the electoral register remain decoupled from one another, and harmonised technical specifications for national ID credentials across the

region are a stated WURI objective for 2026. The regulator runs its own standards programme on the network side, pushing IPv6 adoption and making peering a recurring national exercise from a first forum in August 2025 to Peeringday 2026 in June 2026.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Côte d'Ivoire has no public e-participation platform and meets none of the six participation measures the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index tests (2025), even though it does run a citizen feedback mechanism for public services.

Expert assessments of how policy gets made are far kinder than the public's. Deliberative & Participatory Governance scores 73.6 out of 100 and 8th of 54 African states in 2023, essentially unchanged over the decade, while Public Perception of Political Participation fell 14.8 points to 44.7, 29th of 54. The same split runs through speech: Freedom of Expression & Belief rose 9.3 points to 77.2 out of 100 and 14th of 54, and Media Freedom fell 5.7 points to 69.3, still 8th of 54, while Ivorians' own confidence in free speech is among the ten most deteriorated measures, down 12.6 points to 37.2 out of 100 and 33rd of 54. The room to organise has narrowed from a comparatively open base, with Civil Society Space down 16.7 points to 62.4 and 20th of 54, one of the country's ten most deteriorated indicators, and Freedom of Association & Assembly unchanged at 50.0.

Consultation on individual projects is narrow: the public consultation for the Grand-Bassam data centre reached 12 of 15 identified stakeholders and drew opinions from seven (October 2022). Government tends to answer when challenged rather than as routine — the state IT company published a clarification note defending how the interoperability platform was procured, and what the public knows about the platform comes through ministerial and press announcements rather than any dashboard or transparency report on its governance and data-sharing agreements. Access to the records people would argue from has improved sharply from a low base, yet accountability and transparency remains the country's worst-scoring governance sub-category, flat over the decade.

Finance

Financial sustainability

What the state pays Microsoft has more than doubled in two budgets: the 2026 finance law carries FCFA 4.4 billion for Microsoft licences and associated support under the e-GOUV project, a recurrent line on the budget ministry's own vote, against FCFA 2.04 billion in the 2024 law.

In 2024 the state's own money carried 88.8% of the FCFA 90.8 billion appropriated to digital lines. Its 68 digital investment lines, voted at FCFA 18.9 billion, closed 2024 at FCFA 27.4 billion spent after in-year revision.

The 2026 estimates do not print the source of financing against their digital lines (FY2026). The 2026 law splits capital spending between the Treasury and external financing only in aggregate, and the 2024 settlement accounts show the digital acceleration project PADCI opened in-year at FCFA 500 million, financed wholly by loan with no Treasury part.

What the state has put in law is a levy. Article 18 of the 2026 finance law funds two special accounts of the digital ministry, fed by earmarked levies and fees: FCFA 33 billion for universal telecommunications service and FCFA 2.58 billion for telecoms regulation, against FCFA 35.3 billion and FCFA 4.59 billion in 2025, and its tax annex assigns the cyber-security agency ANSSI 2% of the tax on telecoms and money-transfer companies. The levy undershoots its vote: in 2024 the rural-technology levy's transfer to the universal-service agency ANSUT was written down in-year from FCFA 32.3 billion to FCFA 24.4 billion, all of it paid.

Identity is financed partly outside the Treasury. ONECI's director-general said in May 2026 that maintenance of the national identity databases is paid from the office's own budget, into which the Interior ministry's identification transfer rose from FCFA 5 billion in 2024 to FCFA 8.79 billion in 2025 and again in 2026; the audit court found identity-card and passport fees collected by ONECI and the private SNEDAI outside the state's accounts (2022 accounts, reported January 2024).

The minister has put the recurring cost on record: FCFA 15 to 19 billion a year for equipment upgrades after FCFA 40 to 50 billion of capital spending, calling for public-private co-financing (July 2025).

MoUs and other agreements

Côte d'Ivoire's digital agreements are with vendors rather than governments, and the furthest-reaching of them brings a foreign supplier into national policymaking: under a non-binding July 2025 memorandum, the Emirati firm G42 Presight is to collaborate with the digital ministry on the country's next national digital development strategy, alongside a second non-binding memorandum of the same month on modernising the public administration. Beyon Connect, Post Connect and La Poste de Côte d'Ivoire signed a memorandum in November 2025 for a six-month OneID and OneBox proof of concept, putting an outside digital-identity vendor into the postal and identity stack, and George Mason University and Cybastion hold a memorandum with the ministry covering artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity skills.

The domestic agreements run through operators already on the ground. Raxio Côte d'Ivoire and ARTCI signed a memorandum for Raxio's Grand-Bassam data centre to host the third point of presence of CIVIX, the national internet exchange, and Raxio has a second memorandum on data sovereignty, to host government workloads in its CIV1 facility. Orange Côte d'Ivoire and UNDP signed on 21 May 2026 to take digital skills and youth entrepreneurship beyond Abidjan, an education pact with French Tech Abidjan feeds some 75 firms into technical and vocational curricula, and Orange Bank Africa and the SGPME signed two partial portfolio-guarantee conventions on 23 July 2026 to widen small-enterprise credit.

New investments

The largest single package committed to Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate is American, and none of it is evidenced as moving: the US Export-Import Bank-backed package Cybastion is authorised to deliver — a sovereign national data centre, a government digitisation platform, smart border surveillance — stood at USD 170 million in July 2026. It follows a USD 66 million data-centre guarantee approved in August 2025 and a USD 47 million financing approved in August 2025 for the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, which EXIM's chairman presented as countering the influence of the People's Republic of China, both supported under EXIM's China and Transformational Exports Program.

Chinese lending is older, larger and largely spent. Two Bank of China agreements of 31 August 2018, CFA 53,267,282,421 and CFA 8,724,228,100, financed a Huawei contract for the education ministry's data centre and network, and were fully disbursed by September 2022. CFA 48,316,189,461 and CFA 7,948,624,543, signed 22 May 2019, put fibre and licence-plate cameras into six cities and were disbursed by mid-2021. A CFA 73,931,502,506 loan of April 2020 for a national emergency command centre and surveillance towers at 46 sites was 75 per cent disbursed at end-2022, and a CFA 72,678,277,635 loan for a third surveillance phase 66.4 per cent.

An IDA credit of FCFA 84,356,070,200 for phase 1 of the Projet d'accélération digitale was ratified by decree on 4 February 2026, the approved first phase of a USD 330 million World Bank envelope to 2035. The African Development Bank is putting UA 63,968,067 into e-government over 2023–2028, KfW e-governance with EUR 20 million to 2027, and the European Union grants of EUR 3.5 million to 2031 for private-sector support and EUR 1,715,000 to 2026.

Close to thirty commitments, over two dozen projects, are on record for 2018–2026, worth well over USD 1 billion, with windows running to 2031. Most are debt. Bank of China accounts for something near half of the country-specific total, ahead of the US Export-Import Bank and the World Bank; around a third of the money is approved rather than evidenced as moving. More of it funds state security and government administration than connectivity or inclusion.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Côte d'Ivoire's largest connectivity programme is not aimed at households. Its connectivity component is scoped to public facilities — schools, health establishments, courthouses, social centres, city halls and sub-prefectures, and the regional directorates of the education, health and social ministries, and its target of 648,572 people newly using broadband by 2030 includes 20,000 students attending school, 1,250 health-institution employees, 850 employees in city halls and sub-prefectures and 250 in tribunals (September 2025). Phase 1 is fenced to Abidjan, Yamoussoukro and twelve regions selected on poverty and low connectivity, with national expansion left to a Phase 2.

Beneath the mobile market there is almost nothing else: the regulator counted 178,047 fixed internet subscribers and 302,398 fixed telephone lines against 33,807,850 mobile subscribers (2018), and its own measurement put mobile coverage at 97% of the population but 83% of the territory, a fourteen-point gap population-weighted headlines hide. Reach is not use. 4G covered 91% of the population (2022) while 41% of individuals used the internet (2024), on international bandwidth of 47 kbit/s per user (2022), and the country levies the highest combined handset tax in Africa.

The satellite tier opened in 2026. The digital minister announced a 12-month provisional licence for Starlink alongside the launch of 5G (June 2026), after Orange began selling satellite broadband on Eutelsat KONNECT capacity into areas the terrestrial network does not reach (January 2026) and MTN struck its own Eutelsat deal for rural white areas (April 2026).

Where traffic goes is the regulator's current preoccupation. More than 33,000 km of fibre had been deployed by 2024, but one internet exchange point is active, with 13 to 14 members (2025); ARTCI has signed a memorandum with Raxio to host a third point of presence of the national exchange, CIVIX, at Grand-Bassam (June 2025), convened a national peering forum (August 2025) and run Peeringday 2026 (June 2026). A regional workshop in Abidjan reached consensus in June 2026 on a consortium of licensed operators to commercialise spare fibre on the TRANSCO CLSG transmission network, which Liberia wants as a terrestrial route through Côte d'Ivoire and Guinea against its dependence on one submarine cable.

Data Storage

Commercial hosting capacity is older than the recent openings suggest: MTN opened a 336 m2 modular data centre at Yopougon on 5 June 2014, and offered third-party colocation at four sites, in Marcory, Bingerville, Yopougon and Yamoussoukro, in its 2024 interconnection catalogue. Orange's Tier III GOS data centre at Grand-Bassam, built in 2016 at 1.3MW, hosts services for the operator's 18 Middle East and Africa subsidiaries, and MainOne opened a Tier III colocation facility beside its Abidjan cable landing station in December 2019. Raxio's CIV1 at Grand-Bassam opened in 2024, Uptime Institute Tier III certified with 400 racks and 3MW of IT power; ST Digital opened a Tier III data centre at Grand-Bassam in October 2025 with OVHcloud, billed ahead of its opening as the country's first sovereign Tier III data centre. No global hyperscale provider runs a region in the country, so enterprises needing hyperscale cloud connect to regions outside West Africa.

The government's own platform is still a building site. The National Data Centre at the VITIB technology zone in Grand-Bassam was just over 20% complete in December 2025, delivered by Cybastion with US EXIM backing and targeted for delivery at the end of 2026, construction of its sovereign core having begun in May 2025. EXIM approved a $66m guarantee for it in August 2025, the first data centre the bank has backed anywhere in sub-Saharan Africa — 39.6bn FCFA — with Cybastion working alongside Cisco, HPE and Schneider Electric as technology partners, and the scope had widened well beyond a data centre by July 2026. One ministry already keeps a second site: the budget ministry opened a shared disaster-recovery data centre at Yamoussoukro in July 2021, replicating customs, tax and budget data outside Abidjan. A second state facility is not yet under construction: a Tier 3 administration data centre on the polytechnic's grounds at Yamoussoukro, under the African Development Bank-led e-government project, had its site visited in September 2026, the project counting five administration data centres of which four are functional, and its steering committee noted delays in the works on 18 September 2026.

What may be hosted abroad turns on the destination: personal data may be transferred only to a country offering an equal or higher level of protection. The draft cybersecurity strategy for 2026-2030 extends the state's scope to cloud for the first time.

Energy

Between a quarter and a third of Ivorians remain off the grid — 72.4% had access to electricity (2023) — and the firms that are connected reported around four electrical outages a month in the World Bank's 2023 enterprise survey. Access is nonetheless one of the faster-moving governance measures, up 14.4 points over 2014-2023 to 56.2 out of 100 and 15th of 54 African states (2023), and infrastructure as a whole is the second largest driver of the country's governance improvement, up 13.8 points to 59.3 and 11th of 54. Rural access lags urban access by a wide margin (2020).

Hydroelectricity supplies about 24% of generation (2023). Off-grid policy is the more developed part of the framework: the World Bank's RISE assessment records a comprehensive off-grid regime, with the rural electrification programme PDER providing subsidies and provision for private participation (2024). Coverage is near-universal on the ministry's own series and reliability is not: 8,690 localities were electrified at end-2024 against 3,887 in 2017, on a coverage rate of 94.3% and an access rate of 98.6%, while mean annual interruption time rose back to 26h13 in 2024 from 17h54 in 2021 against a 2030 target of under fifteen hours (2024).

What the grid means for hosting shows in how data centres are designed to survive it. The operating-phase environmental risks identified for the Grand-Bassam facility are generator fuel and lubricant spills, wastewater, NOx and VOC emissions, and water consumption — the risk list of a building expected to run on its own generators.

Technical Capacity

The state was still recruiting the people meant to run its digital agenda in 2026: the Ministry of Digital Transition opened a call on 26 May 2026 for six senior posts covering artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, legal regulation of the digital economy, information systems, digital transformation of the administration and digital infrastructure. The depth thins below the top: the statistical system's capacity scores 44.2 out of 100, against 62.4 for public administration as a whole (2023). The government's own public-sector digital skills provision is recorded as only partly in place (2025).

Operating expertise at the top of the private network is contracted out. Huawei's global network operations centre has partnered on Orange Côte d'Ivoire's network monitoring and operations for ten years, a partnership overseeing operations across more than twelve subsidiaries and over 100 million customers (April 2026).

The domestic pipeline runs through the public Ecole Supérieure Africaine des TIC and a small set of private and international providers, and the organised developer community is concentrated in Abidjan around groups such as Code d'Ivoire.

Cybersecurity

Côte d'Ivoire has been governing its digital estate under an expired strategy. The text in force as at 23 July 2026 was still the 2021-2025 strategy adopted in December 2021, its successor a draft still to be finalised for the Council of Ministers. ANSSI-CI put that draft to stakeholder review on 23 July 2026, on five axes — ethical governance and the legal framework, human capital and innovation, critical-infrastructure protection and cyber-resilience, the state's technical and operational capacity, and cooperation — extending the previous scope to artificial intelligence, emerging information technologies and cloud, and adding a strengthened monitoring and evaluation mechanism resting on performance indicators. The draft is a déclinaison of the fifth pillar of the national digital development strategy.

The binding layer is older and more concrete. Decree No. 2021-916 brought the General Information Systems Security Reference Framework and a Critical Infrastructure Protection Plan into force, and the national response team CI-CERT operates alongside a requirement that essential service operators regularly evidence their security implementation (2023). ANSSI-CI has commissioned a national public key infrastructure, the first sovereign root of trust for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory (July 2026), named as underpinning electronic signature and the national digital identity. The country sits in the third, "establishing" tier of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024.

Some of the estate is defended commercially rather than by the state. Inbound international A2P messaging on Moov Africa's network — the channel one-time passcodes travel on — now comes under an exclusive messaging and firewall agreement between the operator and Omobio (July 2026). Regionally, ECOWAS ministers adopted a directive on confidence-building measures in cyber and ICT which member states are to implement without delay on its publication (October 2024). Internet access and cybersecurity are among the five priorities of the digital ministry's 2026 budget.

DPI

Data Exchange

Ten months after it was switched on, the government's data exchange is still a pilot of twelve institutions: the Unified eXchange Platform went live in Abidjan on 25 September 2025, built by Estonia's Cybernetica and implemented by the state IT company SNDI over a twenty-month project, and its pilot phase still covered twelve public bodies in July 2026.

The contract is worth EUR 387,350, about FCFA 254 million, and covers the platform core, the development of five priority services, and a transfer of skills to SNDI's teams and to the participating administrations (October 2025). The state traces the choice of platform to a national digital-governance roadmap drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on stated criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with its paperless-administration target.

The pilot institutions include the tax directorate, the national civil-status office, the social security fund and the Abidjan trade court. They do not include the education ministry or any passport or immigration authority, so neither function exchanges data through the platform.

Most of what moves between Ivorian administrations moves outside it. The urban land platform SIGFU joins the tax directorate, the land registry, the cadastre and the urban planning administration. The tax directorate's own management system already interfaces with other administrations, and a December 2025 protocol sets up automated exchange with the single window for external trade. A labour market information system run by the national employment and training observatory, built to the SDMX exchange standard and presented as the first interoperable system of its kind in francophone Africa, launched on 23 June 2026. A convention signed in April 2026 is to interconnect the social registry with the identification office's databases and its national population register.

The responsible minister's account of the constraint is direct. The first services put onto the platform were chosen largely because agencies volunteered rather than against user priorities, and he has called for clearer allocation of responsibility between ministries' information-system heads where one public service needs several agencies.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Ivorians report that getting an identity document has become dramatically harder even as civil registration has improved: the perception measure fell 25.1 points over 2014-2023 to 33.2 out of 100 and 27th of 54 African states, the country's single most deteriorated governance indicator.

The biometric card is compulsory for citizens aged 16 and above, identity certificates may be issued to children between 5 and 15, and a national identification number is assigned at birth through the register of natural persons. The card cost 5,000 FCFA, about US$8.40, against a poverty rate of 46%, with supporting documents and transport pushing the real cost well above the fee; civil society groups campaigned against it as exclusionary (2018). Applicants must first obtain a certificate of nationality from a Court of First Instance.

The register was created by decree in 2018, is managed by ONECI and serves as the reference database for other government systems, with nationwide enrolment still under way. There is no single law covering the digital identity lifecycle, and interconnection of personal data files falls under the general 2013 data protection law, which requires interconnection to respect the principle of relevance and use appropriate security measures.

Holding the number buys access. ONECI has opened its online authentication platform against the register to banks, Société Générale Côte d'Ivoire being the first to integrate it in November 2025; a valid identity document has been required to register a SIM card since 2011; and ONECI put the card on a phone with the myONECI+ application in April 2025. Legally resident foreigners are eligible for a biometric residence card, and asylum-seekers were approved for enrolment from 2025.

Civil registration underpins the whole structure: civil status records are by decree a designated source feeding the population register, and other administrations holding relevant personal data must transmit it to ONECI, and most civil status centres are now connected to the Cityweb software that records births, deaths and marriages electronically. The registration itself is going backwards. The share of births registered within the legal deadline fell from 66.8% in 2021 to 56.6% in 2023 and 55.4% in 2024. The government launched a feasibility study on 5 October 2026 for a national authentication platform and identity wallet, built on the national register of natural persons and due by January 2027.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Merchant acceptance more than doubled in a single year: registered merchants taking electronic payments rose from 1,131,590 in 2023 to 2,719,463 in 2024, growth the central bank attributes to QR codes.

Côte d'Ivoire is the union's largest electronic-money market. It carried 34.7% of WAEMU transaction value in 2024, up from 33.4% a year earlier and ahead of Senegal on 30.2%, while its share of transaction volume was 21.4%. It also leads cross-border flows, with about 33 million intra-union operations worth FCFA 1,924 billion in 2024, up 37.95%.

Account holding is measured far less often. 51% of adults held an account at a financial institution or with a mobile money provider in 2021, and an ARTCI household survey in 2017 found 41.94% of people held a mobile money account — 56.00% of men against 26.96% of women. Formal banking access is the country's lowest score on any of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, at 21.4 out of 100 in 2023.

The state pays and collects on its own rail. A presidential decree of 8 May 2024 makes use of the Treasury's TrésorPay-TrésorMoney platform exclusive for non-tax revenue collection and mass public expenditure across all public and parapublic administrations, with TrésorMoney as the Treasury's electronic wallet. Deployment had reached 55% of public services in 2023, against a target of at least 90% for 2024. That wallet is not open money: a WAEMU treasury may issue electronic money only in a closed loop confined to beneficiaries of state allocations, and Côte d'Ivoire's is one of only two treasuries in the union that issues at all.

The BCEAO's instant payment system went live on 30 September 2025 with 45 connected institutions and several major banks staying out; and interoperability becomes mandatory across the union from 30 June 2026. Payment institutions must run a complaints mechanism, and those offering only payment-initiation or account-information services must hold insurance or a guarantee against losses from unauthorised access to account data. Agents at points of sale levy a charge of their own on deposits and withdrawals that no operator tariff provides for. The regional central bank said the Ivorian Treasury, having met all its requirements, already makes regular bulk payments through the Union's instant-payment platform (2026).

Registries

The electoral roll is the electoral commission's own: the Independent Electoral Commission keeps a biometric voter list, consultable on its website and by SMS, and has said the list bears the marks of how civil-status documents have been used. Registration covers roughly half the voting-age population.

There is no single nationwide digital address register. The council of ministers validated a national numeric address code on 26 February 2025, with 14,279 Abidjan streets identified and street plates due by June 2026, and about 17,000 roads had been named across the Abidjan district's 13 communes by September 2025, in a FCFA 12bn project for 500,000 addresses due to finish in Abidjan on 31 December 2025 and to reach 15 cities by 2030.

Land is two registers at two speeds. Urban land runs on SIGFU, which centralises applications, parcel history and cadastral data under a unique parcel identifier and has used electronic signature for title deeds since January 2024, with coverage still short of nationwide. Rural land is at the beginning: the first electronic rural land certificates were signed in March 2026, in the Moronou region, issued through the rural land agency's SIFOR-CI platform in under five months against at least eighteen before.

Business registration is joined up by design: registration at the companies register, the tax administration and the social security fund is shared automatically under a single identifier, processed by CEPICI. Just over 200,000 businesses hold it.

Formal business registration reaches under a fifth of the economic units the country counts.

The social registry had recorded more than 1.45 million households, covering 8.8 million individuals, by August 2025 against a target of more than 2 million over 2021-2025, and a convention signed in April 2026 is to interconnect it with the population register for unique identification and de-duplication. Other registers stand alone: an online list of invalidated driving licences that police can query at roadside checks since July 2025, an online mining cadastre, and civil status certificates requestable online through MonActe over records that are still largely paper, a pilot having digitised 200,000 at Grand-Bassam in 2024. The animal resources ministry said data from the electronic livestock identification system it plans with a French firm will be hosted and secured in Côte d'Ivoire.

At the Abidjan land days of 5 to 7 October 2026 the cadastre director presented the e-Cadastre platform as part of moving cadastre procedures and land-tax payment online by stages.

Sectoral management information systems

The education ministry's new management information system, launched in July 2025 with Millennium Challenge Corporation funding, was piloted in the Bouaké and San-Pedro regions and awaits financing to go national, and validation of the instruments for the sector's digitisation baseline study was completed only in December 2025.

Health is only partly digital. The two main disease-surveillance tools, MAGPI and DHIS2, still depend on paper forms at facility level. Digital capture has reached community health through mHealth.ci, a health ministry platform piloted in five districts of the Poro region with UNICEF support since January 2025, whose workers use smartphones with household registration, prenatal follow-up and vaccination modules integrated with DHIS2. A decree of July 2024 makes the health insurance registration number the mandatory unique health identifier across public and private facilities.

Revenue administration is the strongest function on the narrowest base. Budgetary and financial management scores 83.3 out of 100 and fourth of 54 African states in 2023, while the tax directorate put the entire taxpayer base across all non-property taxes at around 130,000 in the third quarter of 2021, roughly one taxpayer per 125 residents, a ratio it called low. A customs management system is in use on commercial off-the-shelf software, and the treasury system is used extensively by all ministries, departments and agencies.

The civil service runs human-resource and payroll systems, and a social insurance and pension system whose primary scheme also serves public employees. The agriculture ministry's October 2025 initiative with NEC — an e-voucher input distribution system and a farm database covering an initial 30,000 hectares — issues registered farmers ID cards carrying biometric data. Policing runs 105 interconnected processing sites in the judicial and investigative services under the West African Police Information System, with urban video protection covering all 12 police prefectures. The project's steering committee heard that 268 health establishments had been connected to the hospital information system and the computerised patient record in the first phase (2025).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Côte d'Ivoire now has a shortlist of what to build. A national prioritisation workshop closed on 4 September 2026 having examined 140 of 620 inventoried public services through nine working groups, retaining 59 for immediate priority and expecting ten quick wins by the end of 2026 — among them diploma authentication, digital proof of life for pensioners, the computerised patient record and a digital post box; the list itself is not published, and the minister put a governance framework for the digital transition ahead of it as the first priority, against ministries each building their own tools and platforms. The national public service portal is informational only, assessed at level 1 or 2 of the World Bank's online service maturity scale rather than as transactional, on the GovTech Maturity Index 2025 update.

What a citizen can actually transact sits on separate platforms, and the fastest-moving of them is justice. All 39 first-instance tribunals were connected to the e-Justice network in June 2026, seventeen months after it opened as a two-court pilot at Dabou and Yopougon covering nationality certificates only; it authenticates users against ONECI's VERIF application. The certificate of nationality can be applied for, paid for and received online through the e-justice.ci platform, each document carrying a visible electronic seal. The tax directorate's e-impots portal takes online declaration and payment, though it had registered only about 74,000 users by March 2022.

La Poste launched MaPoste in January 2026, a digital mailbox backed by the national identification number and the population register that also delivers the identity card to the door. Drivers could see their digital licence and their points balance on a phone by May 2026. The transport-fluidity observatory put a statistical data platform mapping corridors and roadblocks into service in April 2026, and Cybastion is building an enterprise resource planning system and a business-registration platform for the commerce ministry.

An electronic government procurement system is in use, covering online tendering and contract management. The frame around all of it is a paperless public administration by 2030, against which an inventory under the World-Bank-cofinanced PADCI programme mapped 232 public services across four categories and five priority sectors, and PADCI itself funds the creation and operationalisation of digital agencies and AI-governance frameworks alongside digital skills. What is missing is the return channel: none of the six e-participation measures the GovTech index tests is met.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

What has reached Côte d'Ivoire's local tier has arrived as connectivity and as national systems landing in local buildings, rather than as systems local government runs for itself: the World Bank-financed digital acceleration programme funds broadband to city halls, sub-prefectures and regional directorates, its broadband targets count employees in city halls, sub-prefectures, tribunals and social centres, and every first-instance tribunal was connected to the e-Justice network by 30 June 2026. Electronic collection of local authorities' own revenue through the Treasury's Net-Collect platform was instituted by decree in November 2019.

The registers a local administration would work from are Abidjan's. There is no single nationwide digital address register: addressing is effective in parts of Abidjan, with an addressing project under way in Yamoussoukro, Daloa and Korhogo, and an urban-planning geoportal for Greater Abidjan, to be built over 2025-2027 with Japanese cooperation, was launched as a smart-city project in June 2026. The municipal initiative on record is Abidjan's too: the commune of Plateau is having a shared underground network built for all telecommunications operators, with works due to start within months (May 2026).

A development bank approved a pilot in 2021 to digitise tax registers and collection in 22 municipalities. The SYGIDAN-Recettes software was pre-validated in April 2024 as the national tool for the pilot communes from January 2025. Assinie-Mafia received its taxpayer database on 9 December 2025.

Rural digital data capture

Rural land is the one part of Côte d'Ivoire's rural record moving backwards: Rural Land & Water Access fell 20.8 points over 2014-2023 to 40.3 out of 100 and 39th of 54 African states, one of the country's ten most deteriorated governance measures, set against a rural economy scoring 72.5 and ranking 10th of 54 in 2023, led by rural market access at 85.0 and rural economy support at 83.0.

What is captured digitally at the rural front line comes in bounded pieces. 98% of civil status centres were computerised and connected to the Cityweb software by March 2026; a smartphone platform piloted in the Poro health region connects community and frontline health workers to DHIS2; and the first electronic rural land certificates were signed in the Moronou region in March 2026, an early stage for a system created only in February 2025. Agriculture is building a register of its own: the agriculture ministry's e-voucher and farm database, built with NEC, issues registered farmers ID cards carrying biometric data.

The state's answer is to connect buildings. The World Bank-financed digital acceleration programme funds broadband to schools, health establishments, courthouses, social centres, city halls and sub-prefectures, while the World Bank's RAPID-CI is fenced in its first phase to Abidjan, Yamoussoukro and twelve regions selected on poverty and low connectivity, with national expansion left to a second phase. The reach into villages is left to programme and partnership: a digital-inclusion programme branded « Nos villages connectés » is extending connectivity to villages (July 2025), and Brastorne, which brings rural users online through low-bandwidth services, planned to enter the country through a partnership with Orange by the end of March 2026 (February 2026).

Technology

AI

The only artificial intelligence running in Ivorian public service delivery is a chatbot: EMY 101 answers citizens' administrative queries on WhatsApp and Messenger, and since March 2026 on a toll-free 101 line, giving civil-status and tax guidance and taking problem reports. The government's own data-exchange layer carries no analytics, data-quality or predictive capability of that kind.

The policy is far ahead of the practice, and says so itself. The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy to 2030 describes AI adoption within the public administration as embryonic. It is costed at 912bn FCFA across 15 objectives and 109 projects over five years (February 2025), and the package it belongs to provides for a sovereign cloud, a "Safe AI" label and a National Committee to steer implementation. It was presented to the private sector in May 2025, and the ministry opened recruitment for senior digital posts, among them an innovation and AI adviser, as the strategy was put into effect (May 2026).

The rules to govern any of it are still being bought rather than applied: PADCI's first phase funds technical assistance and equipment to create and make operational the country's digital agencies and its artificial-intelligence governance frameworks (February 2026). In the meantime the country speaks on AI governance abroad through its digital minister, who led a delegation including the telecoms regulator ARTCI to Geneva in July 2026, and at the UN AI Governance Dialogue the same month called for an African AI, by Africans, for Africans.

Compute in country is thin: ST Digital announced NVIDIA GPU-based AI hosting in Abidjan and Douala, with service from the second quarter of 2025 (February 2025), and the consultancy Artefact opened an Abidjan office in May 2025 and made it its Francophone Africa hub. Where the state has added AI capability itself, it has done so through staff rather than procurement: around twenty officials of the transport-fluidity observatory were trained at its Abidjan headquarters from 28 to 30 July 2026 to build their own AI assistants for their directorates' routine work, with the final day given to testing what they had built.

ICT Industry

The largest fiscal contribution from the Ivorian digital economy comes from a partly foreign-owned operator, not a state holding: Orange Côte d'Ivoire paid FCFA 110.3bn of the FCFA 169bn raised in 2023 from companies operating under public-service delegation. The state portfolio's technology, telecoms and post segment improved its net results by FCFA 10.5bn between 2022 and 2023, but the gain came from the trade-facilitation and administrative-systems side of it: GUCE CI, QUIPUX-Afrique, AIGF, SNDI and PCI added a cumulative FCFA 17.4bn in 2023, while Orange Côte d'Ivoire, ANSUT and VITIB SA fell by a cumulative FCFA 6.9bn.

The universal-service agency sits on the weaker side of that ledger: the seven non-commercial state bodies that include ANSUT saw net results fall by a cumulative FCFA 19.8bn in 2023. Regulation has moved the other way: business and competition rules are among the country's ten most improved governance measures, up 20.6 points over 2014-2023 to 57.8 out of 100 and 19th of 54 African states in 2023.

The domestic sector is concentrated in Abidjan and centred on fintech, agritech, e-commerce, logistics and edtech, with early-stage capital coming from international investors and development finance institutions rather than domestic venture funds. Abidjan has become a regional base for foreign platforms: Yango Group opened its continental headquarters there in 2025, its largest African office, and its largest local fleet owner GoCab had delivered 100 electric vehicles to driver-partners by July 2026, half of a 200-vehicle programme. Ivorian firms take some state work: Digital Afrique Telecom is the local partner on the public-administration interoperability platform, and the state has launched Tradepost, an e-commerce platform for traders (December 2025).

The physical base for the sector remains modest against its ambitions. At the VITIB free zone at Grand-Bassam, the first 180-hectare tranche of earthworks, roads and utilities is complete, the perimeter secured and the business hotel built and housing about ten firms (February 2025). A national Industry 4.0 strategy, developed with UNIDO and German funding, was handed to government in February 2025, and the national development plan targets raising the digital sector's share of GDP from 6% to 15% by 2030.

Innovation ecosystem

A startup law has been passed to open public procurement to certified startups (July 2025), the 2026 finance law gave labelled startups three years' exemption from profits and banking taxes, and the state has gone on building the machinery around it. The Ministry of Digital Transition launched two accelerator programmes in Abidjan on 29 July 2026 — Ivoire Tech Next 15, for 15 startups trading at least a year with a commercialised product, and Ivoire Tech Scale Up, for 15 digital SMEs averaging at least 500m FCFA of turnover, each cohort accompanied for 24 months, with applications closing on 13 September 2026. They sit alongside the Ivoire Tech Forum, the government's flagship convening for the startup economy, launched in July 2025, and a channel on which the state publishes its own digital-transformation projects for startups and SMEs to bid on.

Domestic financing has a visible anchor: the state-backed CDC-CI Capital has become the country's most active domestic startup investor, making regular seed-stage grants and equity or convertible investments including in Djamo, Julaya, ADES and Flot (2026). A technological innovation fund for startups was launched in July 2025.

A continental mapping counted 36 active innovation hubs in Côte d'Ivoire in 2021, putting it among the dozen or so African markets with 20 or more and ahead of most of Francophone West Africa, among them Impact Hub Abidjan, Jokkolabs and OVillage alongside the publicly backed Hub Ivoire Tech campus in the Plateau. The country nonetheless ranks 112th of 133 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, and the newly handed-over national digital-fabrication laboratory at Cocody adds plant whose recurrent funding has not been set out. The digital minister announced a platform through which labelled startups are to reach the fiscal framework's mechanisms; no date or criteria are stated.

The economy ministry launched the Fintech Sector Support Project on 6 October 2026 through its financial inclusion promotion agency, with African Development Bank backing, to support fintech firms beyond payments and money transfers.

Capacity

Literacy

Côte d'Ivoire has the teachers and not the results they are meant to produce: on the Ibrahim Index, human resources in education is among its ten best-scoring measures at 92.6 out of 100 and 11th of 54, up 8.8 points over the decade, while the index's education quality score sits at 40.7 and 30th of 54, up 2.7, and education completion at 43.1 and 22nd of 54 (2023). Staffing is not what holds the administration back, and a decade of gains in it has not moved what comes out the other end.

Education is the third worst-scoring of the country's governance sub-categories at 50.2 and 29th of 54, held down by enrolment at 33.6 — one of its ten worst-scoring indicators — and by equality in education at 41.6, both 36th of 54, though both have risen over the decade (2023). Whether children are in school at all, and which children, remains the weaker half of the picture.

The floor for using a digital system at all is lower still: the regulator's 2017 ICT household survey found 32.4% of individuals using a computer, 42.2% in urban areas against 21.9% in rural ones, and 38.3% of men against 26.2% of women (2017). Lower digital literacy is also one of the barriers that keeps women off the mobile internet, alongside social norms, handset affordability and not knowing what the internet is for, rather than any explicit bar on access.

The state's own view of its schools is being rebuilt rather than read off a running system. A Bank of China-financed digital education project for the education ministry was fully disbursed by 2022, yet the education management information system launched in July 2025 went live at pilot scope, and the technical validation of the instruments for the sector's digitisation baseline study was only completed in December 2025. Reaching households that French-language messaging does not is being handled the analogue way, by training announcers in local languages to relay civil-status and identification information (June 2026).

Training and skills

Almost everything that trains Ivorians in digital skills is somebody else's programme. What the state runs for its own officials reaches basic data science and data literacy and no further (2025).

PADCI's first phase funds advanced and intermediate digital skills training aimed at young people and women alongside the digitisation of public services in selected social sectors (February 2026). Around it sit partnerships: Orange Côte d'Ivoire and UNDP signed a memorandum on 21 May 2026 to take digital skills and youth entrepreneurship beyond Abidjan; an education pact with French Tech Abidjan, the PIETP, brings some 75 firms into technical and vocational curricula (June 2026); and the Cocody UniPod opens to students, graduates, artisans, start-ups and teacher-researchers, targets 50% women and states an intake from rural communities, covering prototype-to-enterprise work from fintech to agritech (August 2026).

The pipeline it all draws on is narrow at the top. Tertiary ICT teaching is anchored by the public École supérieure africaine des TIC, founded in 2012, ISO 9001-certified, a certification centre for Cisco, Microsoft and Oracle and offering Franco-Ivorian double degrees, with private and international providers alongside it; the organised developer community it feeds is concentrated in Abidjan around groups such as Code d'Ivoire. That base performs: Ivorian students won the cloud computing category at the Huawei ICT Competition world final in 2025 and were sent to China again in 2026, making that a standing route for technical trainees.

Inside the administration the training is small and specific rather than programmatic: Estonia's Cybernetica, with Digital Afrique Telecom, ran a 38-participant seminar for SNDI and administration staff on operating the interoperability platform (July 2026), and around twenty staff of the transport-flow observatory were trained over 28-30 July 2026 to build their own AI assistants. On absorption, a World Bank youth employment and skills project carries digital literacy and ICT training together with a digital job-matching platform, and the ministry itself advertised six senior posts in May 2026 covering AI, cybersecurity and digital-economy regulation.

Research institutions

Côte d'Ivoire's first national digital-fabrication and innovation laboratory was handed over by UNDP at the Lycée technique de Cocody in Abidjan, with the education ministry as contracting authority (July 2026). It is a serious plant: 16 functional zones across five poles — mechanical and wood workshops, electronics and robotics, FabLab prototyping, agritech and greentech, and shared coworking — built to Fab Academy standards, with CNC machining, multi-material 3D printers, a laser cutter, drones, robots and 3D scanners, on roughly 100 kW of power.

What has not been published is how it will be kept running: no operating timetable, operating budget or sustainment funding has been disclosed, which leaves the recurrent cost of a 100 kW machine shop inside a public lycée unaccounted for. That is the question to ask of every donated facility, and it is the one the handover did not answer.

The standing institutional base is thinner than the equipment suggests. The public École supérieure africaine des TIC held ITU Centre of Excellence status from 2014 to 2022 and remains the anchor for advanced ICT work, and a public AI university with associated centres of excellence is proposed under the national development plan for 2026-2030 (June 2026).

Inclusion

Access to services

On 3 August 2026 the identity enrolment centre at Grand-Bassam was running on a single agent handling intake, registration and card collection at once, and turned dozens of applicants away by mid-morning; the turn-aways there had been running for weeks. That counter is where the identity system meets the public, and Ivorians' own sense of how easily an identity document can be obtained has fallen further than on any other measure in the country's governance profile.

The pattern is wider than identity. Côte d'Ivoire's inclusion and equality score has been flat across the decade at 54.4 out of 100, with equal socioeconomic opportunity strong at 73.2 but equal access to public services at only 51.9, 17th of 54 and down 1.5 points (2023). The digital front door does not yet stand in for the counter: the national public service portal is informational rather than transactional on the World Bank's 2025 assessment, though the government assistant EMY 101 has answered civil-status and tax questions over WhatsApp, Messenger and a toll-free line since March 2026. Complaints have their own channels: the Miliê citizen portal has taken users' concerns about the administration since 7 February 2019, and the civil-service ministry's user relations centre had handled more than 10,000 requests by toll-free line and its Logirec platform by January 2024.

What keeps people off the online channel is price rather than absence. Only 13.46% of households had internet at home in 2017, and those without it named the price of the service (22.78%) and the cost of equipment (21.69%) far ahead of the service being unavailable in the area, at 6.67%. The device is taxed accordingly: Côte d'Ivoire levies the highest combined handset tax in Africa, at 50% (2025), while a mobile broadband basket cost 2.4% of gross national income per capita in 2022.

Where the state does reach people it increasingly does so through a payment rather than a premises. More than 400,000 households received state cash transfers and accompanying measures between 2017 and 2024; the productive safety-net programme paid its 230,000 active beneficiary households by mobile money in 2024, FCFA 35.19bn having been transferred by the end of that year; and 33,881 asylum-seekers received unconditional monthly transfers in 2024, 142% more than the year before. Non-nationals are inside the system by design — the population register is open by decree to residents, visitors and refugees alike — but asylum-seekers still lacked the unique identifier that access to some financial services depends on when their enrolment was approved for roll-out in 2025.

Digital divides

Women's access to public services in Côte d'Ivoire went backwards over the decade to 2023, falling 4.6 points to 46.0 out of 100 and 24th of 54 African states — one of the few declines inside a women's equality measure that otherwise rose 6.7 points over the same period.

The gender line runs through the devices themselves. Mobile phone ownership stood at 81.38% of men against 47.19% of women in 2017, a 34-point spread on 64.83% ownership nationally; actual use of a phone split 85.27% of men against 58.67% of women; and mobile-money use reached 37.07% of men against 16.08% of women, on 26.91% overall. Ivorian fieldwork puts the cause in social norms, weaker awareness of what the internet is for, the price of a smartphone and lower digital literacy rather than any explicit bar on women's access (2018).

Geography cuts as deep. Household computer ownership was 10.34% in urban areas against 0.28% in rural ones in 2017, a ratio of about thirty-seven to one, and phone ownership 74.67% against 54.36%. Mobile networks already covered nearly all Ivorians in 2018, if much less of the national territory, and electricity access stood at 94% in urban areas against 42% in rural ones (2020).

Beneath both lines sit schooling and registration. Education is among Côte d'Ivoire's weakest governance sub-categories, held down by enrolment and by equality in education (2023), and birth registration was markedly worse in the countryside than in the towns (2016) — so the people least likely to hold a device are also the least likely to hold the record that a digital service will ask them for.

Data

National statistics

The statistical system lags the administration around it: it scored 44.2 out of 100 and ranked 32nd of 54 African states, up only 4.6 points across the decade, inside a public administration sub-category scoring 62.4 and ranking 13th (2023).

The weakness is not in the headline exercises. Population, agricultural and business censuses have all been run within the preceding ten years, and the enterprise and establishment census counted well over a million formal and informal economic units (2025), far more than the formally registered business base. It is the foundations that give way: the country scores above 89% on data use and 70-89% on data products, but 50-69% on data services and infrastructure and only 20-49% on data sources (2023) — the pillar covering censuses, surveys and administrative collection is the worst of the five. The survey programme is concentrated on households and labour, against two health surveys and one each for agriculture and business, leaving the productive side of the economy thinly measured (2023).

Administrative records cannot yet fill the gap: the main disease-surveillance tools depend on paper at facility level (2024), and civil registration remains largely paper-based beyond a digitisation pilot (2024), with on-time birth registration in decline.

Vital statistics are published: the annual civil-status yearbook comes from the Interior Ministry on UNICEF funding (2025). Three decrees on the National Statistical System — the statistical visa, the tariffing of statistical services, and the communication of administrative files — were adopted in the Council of Ministers on 18 June 2025, and a labour market information system built to the SDMX exchange standard launched on 23 June 2026. A publication duty does not guarantee a current series: the telecoms regulator publishes market statistics under article 82 of ordonnance 2012-293, and its Panorama, deposited with the ITU, carries 2018 market data and a household survey with 2017 fieldwork.

Open data

Côte d'Ivoire's record-transparency scores have risen sharply from a low base — disclosure of public records up 22.0 points over 2014-2023 to 50.2 out of 100 and 8th of 54 African states, accessibility of public records up 13.8 points to 40.1 and 17th — while the accountability and transparency sub-category they sit in stayed flat at 40.0 and 24th, the country's worst (2023).

The plumbing is in place. An open government data portal is running and publishing basic information and datasets (2025), a national data governance strategy to 2030 was handed to the Prime Minister on 13 March 2025 alongside the national AI strategy, and the state has an established institution with a whole-of-government digital mandate. Individual registers have gone further than the portal: the mining cadastre is online, built on Landfolio to run the full cycle of mining titles and presented as aligned with EITI standards (September 2025), and a project to develop the Geoportail du Grand Abidjan, an urban-planning data platform to be built over 2025-2027, was launched in June 2026.

What gets published well is what the macro-statistical machinery already produces. On the Open Data Inventory the strongest categories are balance of payments, government finance and health facilities at 7.5 out of 10, then prices and gender statistics at 7.0, while the weakest scored categories are energy and education outcomes at 4.5 and pollution and resource use at 5.0 (2024). Two categories — digital and communications, and food security — carry no score at all.

Across the 21 categories that carry a score the average is 6.0 out of 10 (2024), with economic data at 6.5 and social data at 6.1 against 5.2 for environmental data, the thinnest of the three domains.

Openness about the state's own systems is another matter. What is known about the interoperability platform at the centre of the government's data-sharing plans comes through ministerial and press announcements rather than routine reporting, with no public dashboard or transparency report on its governance or its data-sharing agreements (2025), and the central bank's report on the union's payment infrastructures for 2022-2023 appeared in April 2025.

Use of satellite data

The nearest thing to a public geospatial platform is metropolitan rather than national: a project to develop the Geoportail du Grand Abidjan, an urban-planning data platform to be built with Japanese cooperation over 2025-2027, was launched in June 2026 to promote a smart-city approach. In agriculture, a Huawei platform to map agricultural plots, set against traceability demands in cocoa and cashew under European environmental rules, received preliminary ministerial approval in May 2026.

What has moved fast is satellite communications, which is a different capability. Orange sells satellite broadband over Eutelsat KONNECT capacity into rural areas the terrestrial network does not reach (January 2026), MTN followed with its own KONNECT capacity deal for rural white areas (April 2026), and Starlink was given a 12-month provisional licence alongside the launch of 5G (June 2026). That is capacity to connect the territory, not capacity to observe it. The environment ministry signed a framework memorandum with an Ivorian company to monitor land use and carbon stocks from satellite data (2026).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Côte d'Ivoire's first national data centre is being built by a Washington firm on United States export credit: construction at the VITIB technology zone in Grand-Bassam, delivered by Cybastion with US EXIM Bank backing, was under way in December 2025 with delivery targeted for end-2026, work having started in May 2025. The

Export-Import Bank approved a guarantee for the centre in August 2025, the first data centre it has backed anywhere in sub-Saharan Africa, and had approved on 14 August 2025 a second, for the digitisation of the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, covering its information systems, cybersecurity, cloud integration and administrative efficiency; the two were announced together in September 2025 as more than US$100 million in guarantees under the United States' China and Transformational Exports Program. By July 2026 the package Cybastion had been formally authorised by the Ivorian government to deliver covered the data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart border surveillance system, with Cisco as a technology partner, the build drawing on United States technology partners including Cisco, HPE and Schneider Electric.

Commercial American infrastructure is older than the state programme: Equinix has owned and operated an Abidjan data centre and the Ivorian landing station of the MainOne submarine cable since April 2022, and Starlink was live in the country by 17 July 2026 after talks in March 2026 that put its market entry and tech-hub development on the bilateral agenda. In government systems, the education management information system launched in July 2025 with Millennium Challenge Corporation funding, and the state has held discussions with Visa, in May 2026, on postal financial services and startup financing. On skills, Cybastion's DigiEmpower programme is a five-year training commitment and a memorandum between George Mason University, Cybastion and the ministry covers artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity skills.

China activities

Chinese money in Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate has gone overwhelmingly into security systems. Bank of China loans signed in May 2019 financed phase two of the video surveillance platform, installing fibre and Huawei cameras with licence-plate readers in Abidjan, Yamoussoukro, Bouaké, Odienné, Korhogo and San Pedro and in April 2020 phase three, adding further cable, cameras and a traffic monitoring system using licence-plate readers, again implemented by Huawei. A separate loan of April 2020 financed phase two of the Ministry of Interior and Security's unified communication system — a two-floor national emergency command centre for police, military and fire services, surveillance towers at 46 locations in 22 cities and an integrated military IT network, contracted to China Railway Construction International Group. Two earlier buyer's credits, of September 2018 and March 2019, financed an integrated information system for the armed forces, recorded as completed on 31 December 2020, and two loan agreements of August 2018 financed phase one of the Digital Education Project against a Huawei commercial contract with the education ministry, funding a VoIP unified communication system, a dedicated data transmission network and a data centre for the ministry, fully disbursed by September 2022.

Chinese lending is the largest single source of external finance recorded for Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate, ahead of both the US Export-Import Bank and the World Bank.

Huawei's commercial position runs alongside the loan book: its global network operations centre had partnered on Orange Côte d'Ivoire's network operations for ten years by April 2026, the government is engaging with it on a government super-app model for public administration (May 2026), and has given preliminary approval to a Huawei smart-agriculture platform to map agricultural plots, amid traceability demands in cocoa under European environmental rules (May 2026). The training route is the vendor's own competition: Ivorian students won the cloud computing category at the Huawei ICT Competition world final and were received in Abidjan in May 2025, and were sent to China again in May 2026.

EU activities

The layer government data exchange runs on is Estonian. The Unified eXchange Platform was launched in Abidjan on 25 September 2025, built by Estonia's Cybernetica and implemented by SNDI under a 20-month project, the product being an improved version of X-Road, and the state traces the choice to a national digital-governance roadmap

drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on stated criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with the paperless-administration target. Skills transfer has begun: Cybernetica, with Digital Afrique Telecom, delivered a training seminar for SNDI and administration staff on running the platform in July 2026, and the government studied the Estonian model again at a Europe-East Africa digital public infrastructure session held in Estonia in May 2026.

European financing sits mainly on governance and small enterprise. KfW is financing a concessional loan running 2024-2027 to strengthen central e-governance structures, including rehabilitation and extension of the central state administrative network and the standardised digital processes behind online services. The European Union funds a private-sector programme running 2022-2031 that combines corporate social responsibility with digital initiatives and work on the legal and regulatory framework and « DigiGreen & Agri », running 2024-2026, on digital innovation for the low-carbon transition and youth employability. A national Industry 4.0 strategy was developed with UNIDO and German funding and handed to government in February 2025.

On infrastructure, the French cloud provider OVHcloud built ST Digital's Grand-Bassam data centre with it (October 2025), and the Via Africa submarine cable project, whose consortium includes Orange and Orange Côte d'Ivoire, announced in May 2026, plans a landing in Côte d'Ivoire on an Atlantic route from Europe to South Africa. France is also where the country presents itself: the national strategy Côte d'Ivoire Numérique 2030 was presented at VivaTech in June 2025, a startup delegation returned to VivaTech 2026, and the country took part in the Paris AI Action Summit in February 2025.

Gulf/UAE activities

A foreign vendor has a hand in Côte d'Ivoire's next national digital strategy: one of two non-binding memoranda signed with the UAE's G42 Presight in July 2025 sets a framework for collaboration with the digital ministry on it, the other a framework for modernising the public administration. The one commitment here with money behind it is the Islamic Development Bank's, financing digital transformation and health security in healthcare services through 2029, developing health information systems and digital health platforms in support of the National Health Development Plan.

India activities

India's recorded involvement is as a lender, past and prospective: the Grand-Bassam technology zone VITIB, built with an early Export-Import Bank of India loan, was in April 2025 seeking finance from Indian investors and the Export-Import Bank of India for its development plan to 2028. No Indian-built system, bilateral digital agreement or training programme was on record as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

The state-owned data centre meant to bring Côte d'Ivoire's data home was due to open in 2027 as at September 2026, offering government bodies cloud hosting, colocation and connectivity, after the digital minister said in July 2025 that 97% of the country's data was stored abroad. When the national data centre was launched with Cybastion in December 2023 it was to host the systems, applications and data of the state and of every public administration body. The terms on which the Cybastion data-centre contract and Raxio's memorandum to host government workloads govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The rule on where state data sits is a strategy, not a law. The national data governance strategy 2024-2030 requires data classed as critical information infrastructure to be processed and stored inside the country by staff at least 20% Ivorian, keeps non-critical government data in the national data centre or cloud, and allows non-sensitive government data in a public cloud; it set 2025 for a cloud policy, 2026 for the national data centre and 2027 for a national cloud. Government systems were hosted partly inside and partly outside government infrastructure (2025).

The data exchange is the one core system whose contract terms are on record: the state IT company SNDI runs it and presents the Cybernetica contract's complete transfer of skills to its own teams as a guarantee of digital sovereignty. Where the national identity database is hosted, and under whose jurisdiction, had not been published as at September 2026.

For the AI layer, the digital minister set a target in June 2026 of national compute capacity for artificial intelligence within twelve months, placing sovereignty in control of the data rather than ownership of infrastructure. Regionally, the BCEAO had put out to tender a centralised public key infrastructure covering all eight WAEMU states, Côte d'Ivoire among them (July 2026).

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